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SECURITY



UK retail giant Co-op
confirms hackers stole
all 6.5 million customer
records



The chief executive of U.K. retail conglomerate Co-op on Wednesday said that hackers had stolen the personal data of all of the company's customers during an April cyberattack.

Co-op Group CEO Shirine Khoury-Haq told [BBC News](#) that the hackers copied the company's member list of 6.5 million members, but that Co-op shut down its network before the hackers could lock up its systems with ransomware.

The members' data includes names, addresses, and contact information.

IMAGE CREDITS: THE NEW YORK TIMES/GETTY IMAGES

The retailer's network shutdown subsequently resulted in widespread internal disruption across its U.K. back offices and grocery stores.

The [breach at Co-op](#) in April was part of a broader hacking campaign targeting the U.K. retail sector, which also saw [the theft of an unspecified amount of customer data](#) from Marks & Spencer and an attempted cyberattack on Harrods. The cyberattacks were attributed to Scattered Spider, a [collective of mostly young hackers](#) that use deception tactics to trick companies' IT helpdesks into granting them access to their network.

Earlier in July, U.K. authorities [arrested four people for allegedly](#) having links to the retail cyberattacks, including a 20-year-old woman, two men aged 19, and a youth aged 17. The four are accused of

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hacking, blackmail, and participating as a member of an organized crime group.

Since the cyberattacks, the hackers reportedly moved on [to target the airline and transportation industry](#), as well as [insurance companies](#) — sectors that store vast amounts of consumers' data.

It's not known how much the breach at Co-op will cost it. According to [one retail industry news outlet](#), Co-op did not have cybersecurity insurance at the time of the hack, which could result in the company incurring heavy financial costs.

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US insurance giant Aflac says customers' personal data stolen during cyberattack

Zack Whittaker — 7:50 AM PDT · June 23, 2025

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hackers in its system on June 12 and contained the incident. Aflac, which provides supplemental insurance to individuals whose expenses are not covered by their primary providers, said it was not yet known how many customers are affected by the data breach but that the personal data includes customers' claims, such as Social Security numbers and health information.

The breach also included data from Aflac's beneficiaries, employees, and agents, the company said.

Aflac said its systems were not affected by ransomware, but attributed the breach to an unspecified cybercrime group known to be targeting the U.S. insurance industry. According to [its Friday press release](#), Aflac said the hackers used social engineering tactics to break into its network.

An Aflac spokesperson, who did not provide their name, declined to answer TechCrunch's questions when reached by email on Monday.

Aflac, which has around 50 million customers per [the company's website](#), is the latest U.S. insurance company to experience a cyberattack in recent weeks, amid warnings that hackers are targeting the wider insurance industry.

John Hultquist, the chief analyst for Google's threat intelligence unit, said last week that the unit was "aware of multiple intrusions" in the U.S. that bear the hallmarks of activity linked to Scattered Spider,

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a loose-knit collective of hackers and tactics that rely on [social engineering](#) tactics and sometimes threats of violence to target company help desks and call centers in order to gain access to their networks.

The hackers are also [reportedly behind](#) the recent intrusions at [Erie Insurance](#) and [Philadelphia Insurance Companies](#), which disclosed cyberattacks this month, with disruption ongoing.

The hackers linked to Scattered Spider attacks are known to be financially motivated and have been previously linked to cyberattacks and intrusions at [tech giants](#), [casinos](#), and [hotels](#), and [recent data breaches](#) across the U.K. and U.S. retail sector.



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Allianz Life says ‘majority’ of customers’ personal data stolen in cyberattack

Zack Whittaker — 6:40 AM PDT · July 26, 2025

U.S. insurance giant Allianz Life has confirmed to TechCrunch that hackers stole the personal information of the “majority” of its customers, financial professionals, and employees during a mid-July data breach.

When reached by TechCrunch, Allianz Life spokesperson Brett Weinberg confirmed the breach.

“On July 16, 2025, a malicious threat actor gained access to a third-party, cloud-based CRM system used by Allianz Life,” referring to a customer relationship management (CRM) database containing information on its customers. “The threat actor was able to obtain personally identifiable data related to the majority of Allianz Life’s customers, financial professionals, and select Allianz Life employees, using a social engineering technique,” the spokesperson said.

The company disclosed the data breach on Saturday in a [legally required filing](#) with Maine’s attorney general but did not immediately provide a number of how many Allianz Life customers are affected. According to the spokesperson, Allianz Life has 1.4 million customers. Its parent company, Allianz, has more than 125 million customers worldwide.

Allianz Life said it notified the FBI and added it had “no evidence” that any other systems on its network were compromised.

The insurance giant would not say if it had received any communication from the hackers, such as a ransom note. The company also would not attribute the breach to a hacking group.

Allianz Life is the latest company in the past month to have been hacked during a wave of data breaches targeting the wider insurance industry,

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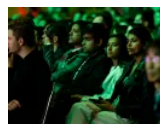
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[including Aflac](#), a major provider of supplementary health insurance. Security researchers at Google said in June that [they were “aware of multiple intrusions” across the insurance sector](#) attributed to Scattered Spider, a collective of hackers and techniques that rely on social engineering methods, such as deceptively calling and tricking help desks into granting them access to a company’s network.

Prior to targeting insurance companies, the Scattered Spider hackers were seen [targeting the U.K. retail industry](#), as well as the [aviation and transportation sectors](#), and are historically known for hacks [targeting Silicon Valley technology giants](#).

Per the Maine filing, Allianz plans to begin notifying affected individuals around August 1.

Do you know more about the Allianz Life cyberattack? Are you an affected customer or employee? Securely contact this reporter via encrypted message at [zackwhittaker.1337](#) on Signal.

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